Does ChatGPT Name Your Business?

The 30-Minute AI-Visibility Playbook

Run the 5-minute test, read the free scores, and fix the three things that actually make AI engines cite you.

A diagnostic and action plan — not a ranking service.

By C2R Marketing · October 2026

$14 one-time

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About this playbook

This playbook was written from real October 2026 audit runs on our own sites — the checker stack, the scores, and the disagreement between them are documented from actual test results, not marketing copy. A diagnostic and action plan: buying it does not move a single score by itself — running the checklist does.

A note before you start

This is not a guru guide. It's a field report from someone who ran the audits.

In October 2026 I ran the full stack of free AI-visibility checkers against my own sites — tovrose.com, nmvbible.org — and wrote up exactly what came back, engine by

engine. The results were humbling: one checker said a site had zero mentions. A different checker, same day, showed ChatGPT naming it with a citation. Both were telling the truth. They just measure different things.

This playbook gives you the same stack I used, what the numbers mean, and the three channels that actually move them — all free, all things you control. Nothing

here is guaranteed: there is no button you press that puts you into ChatGPT's training data. But if you do the 30 minutes of work at the end of this guide, your business will be measurably easier for every AI engine to find, name, and cite.

One rule runs through everything here: **run the tests yourself, twice.** Single checker results are noisy. Your own eyes on your own scores are the only ground truth.

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1. The 5-minute test

Before you touch a single checker, do this. It takes five minutes and it is the single most honest measure of your AI visibility.

- Open ChatGPT (or Gemini, or Perplexity — do all three if you can).
- Ask the exact question your best customer would ask when they don't know you exist. Examples: "Who's the best lawn care service in Blue Springs?" / "What coaching program teaches Hebrew for Bible study?" / "Which [your category] do people recommend?"
- Read the answer. Is your business named? Is it cited? Is a competitor named instead?

Write down what happened: which engines named you, which cited you, who got named instead of you. That's your baseline. Everything in this playbook exists to move that baseline.

Do this first, before the checkers. The checkers below automate parts of this

test — but the manual version tells you exactly what a real customer sees.

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2. The four free checkers

All four are free with no signup (verified October 2026). Use at least two — the chapter after this one shows you why one isn't enough.

Semrush free AI Visibility checker — https://www.semrush.com/free-tools/ai-search-visibility-checker/

Enter your domain. You get 3 free checks per day, no account needed: a 0–100 AI Visibility score, mentions, citations, top-cited pages, topics, and competitors.

The URL of this tool has changed before (an older Semrush path 404'd), so if the link above ever dies, search "Semrush AI search visibility checker".

rank.ai free checker — https://www.rank.ai/free-tools/ai-visibility-checker

Enter one prompt plus your domain. It tests ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini and tells you, per engine: were you mentioned? were you cited? — with the verbatim answer text so you can read exactly what each engine said about you. This is the closest thing to automating Chapter 1's manual test.

HubSpot AI Search Grader — search "HubSpot AI Search Grader".

Enter your brand, product, industry, and location — no signup. It grades ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Gemini on recognition, sentiment, share of voice, and positioning. The detailed perception breakdown asks for your email — skip it; the free grade is the useful part.

Ahrefs AI Visibility Checker — search "Ahrefs AI visibility checker".

Enter your brand name, no signup. As of October 2026 it often sits behind a human-verification checkbox that automated use usually fails. Try it once; if it blocks you, skip it and move on — three checkers is plenty.

What not to enter: no email, no name, no phone, no personal data anywhere. If a checker demands signup, skip it and note why. Decline cookie banners. Screenshot your results — you'll compare them against next month's run.

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3. What your scores actually mean (and why they disagree)

Here's the part nobody else's guide tells you. When I ran the stack on my own sites in October 2026, the checkers disagreed with each other:

- Semrush's free checker gave tovrose.com an **AI Visibility Score of 0 (Low)** — Mentions 0, Citations 1, Audience Reach 0. Top cited pages: the homepage and the author page.
- rank.ai, the same week, tested the prompt *"Who is Tov Rose and what books has he written?"* — **2 of 4 engines named me**, with ChatGPT naming me AND citing my site, Gemini naming me with a citation, and Claude leaving me out entirely.

Same business, same week, opposite verdicts. Neither checker was lying. Semrush measures one snapshot of mentions across its sampling; rank.ai runs your actual prompt through live engines and shows you the verbatim answers. **They measure**

different things, and single-checker variance is large. **That's why the rule is:**

run at least two checkers, read both, and screenshot everything.

What to look for in your own results:

- **Named vs. not named.** The only metric that ultimately matters: does the engine say your name when asked your category question?
- **Cited vs. uncited.** Being named without a citation means the engine is repeating training data, not reading your site. Being cited means it found

you live.

- **What's factually wrong.** Outdated prices, wrong descriptions, a competitor

named as you — flag every error. These are your fix list.

- **Who gets named instead of you.** Those are your real AI-visibility competitors, and they may not be your real-world competitors.

Run all of this monthly. These are one-time snapshots — no alerts, no history.

The re-check is the strategy.

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4. The three channels that get AIs to name you

AI systems learn about your business through three channels. Each has its own

lever, ordered by how fast it works.

Channel 1 — Your own site (you control this; works immediately).

When an AI with web access answers a question about your business, it reads your

site first. Give it clean, machine-readable facts: an llms.txt file (a plain

summary of your business — services, prices, contact, links) in your site's root;

JSON-LD schema markup describing your business as a LocalBusiness or Organization; and — most important — keep your facts IDENTICAL everywhere: name spelling, services, prices, address, phone. AIs cross-check. Contradictions make them hedge or skip you entirely.

Channel 2 — The profiles AIs actually cite (biggest near-term win).

My October audit proved it: when engines answer about a person or business, they cite third-party profiles — Amazon, Goodreads, review sites, directories — more than official domains. For a local business, that means: your Google Business Profile (complete it, keep hours and services current), your reviews on the platforms your customers use, and any directory or marketplace listing that ranks for your category. These are the pages the engines are actually reading. Claim them, complete them, keep them identical to Channel 1.

Channel 3 — The knowledge bases models train on (slow, permanent).

There is no submission form for ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini's training data. Vendors don't take "please know me" requests — that gap is exactly what $499/mo scan products sell into. What feeds training data: Wikipedia-style reference pages, Wikidata-style structured facts, and anything widely republished. New models train on new data every few months. Keep publishing — interviews, articles, guest posts, press. Today's content is next year's training data. Slow, but it's the only channel that compounds without you touching it.

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5. The 30-minute checklist

Do these in order. Set a timer.

Minutes 0–5: The manual test (Chapter 1).

Ask your category question on ChatGPT, Gemini, and Perplexity. Screenshot every answer. Baseline recorded.

Minutes 5–15: Two checkers (Chapter 2).

Run Semrush's free checker on your domain and rank.ai's checker on your category prompt. Screenshot both. Compare: named? cited? what's wrong? who's named instead?

Minutes 15–20: The identity sweep (Channel 1 + 2).

Search your business name. Open your site, your Google Business Profile, and your top two directory listings side by side. Fix any mismatch in name, hours, services, or phone — starting with the Google profile. One identity, everywhere.

Minutes 20–25: The llms.txt.

Add an llms.txt to your site's root: who you are, what you do, services and prices, how to contact you, your best links. Plain text. Under 30 minutes to write; readable by every AI crawler.

Minutes 25–30: Schedule the re-check.

Put a monthly calendar reminder: "AI visibility re-check — 20 minutes." Run the manual test and two checkers, compare screenshots against today's. The trend is the strategy.

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6. What won't work (the honest page)

- **This playbook is a diagnostic and action plan, not a ranking service.**

Buying it does not move a single score by itself — running the checklist does.

- **No one can pay to be named.** If a product promises placement in AI answers

for a fee, treat it the way you'd treat an email selling you the #1 Google

spot.

- **No submission form exists** for ChatGPT/Claude/Gemini training data. Anyone

implying otherwise is selling you Channel 3 speed that doesn't exist.

- **One good month isn't permanent.** Engines re-sample, models re-train, and a

competitor can out-publish you. The monthly re-check is the whole game.

- **Don't chase every engine equally.** Your customers ask their questions on

two or three engines at most. Fix the ones they actually use.

About this playbook

This playbook was written by C2R Marketing from real October 2026 audit runs on

our own sites — the checker stack, the scores, and the disagreement between

them are all documented from actual test results, not marketing copy.

Price: **$14 one-time.** No subscription, no upsell inside.

What we don't do: we sell no checker software, take no affiliate cut from any

tool named in this guide, and guarantee no outcome. The checkers are free; the checklist is free; you're paying for the field notes that put them in order.

Questions or a score you want a second pair of eyes on: reply to any C2R Marketing email, or find us at c2rmarketing.com.

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